



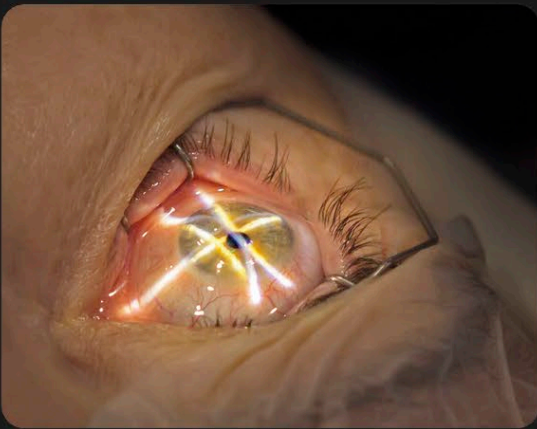
Lidar

Lidar technology (light detection and ranging) works by reflecting laser beams off a target object. This provides data so a computer can build a 3D model of the target. Self-driving cars use lidar, among other tools, to navigate through their surroundings.



Laser cutting

Laser beams can be used to cut materials. The narrow, powerful beam is pointed at the material, causing it to heat up. The material in the beam's path melts, burns, or vaporizes, leaving a clean edge.



Delicate surgery

Lasers have many surgical applications. In laser eye surgery, an ultraviolet laser is used to remove a thin layer of the eye, reshaping it so that the eye can focus light better.



Laser-guided telescopes

The power and precision of laser beams means they don't spread out very much. At the Very Large Telescope in Chile, astronomers use lasers that help guide computers mapping the movement of stars.